

# Vimpower yourself

Vim, a relic from the past? Or a tool that stood the test of time? There are those who swear by it and then there are those view it as crazy.



The only downside to using Vim is the learning curve steeper than a cliff. But if you're going to spend hours every day programming for the rest of your life then learning Vim is the second best investment to touch typing.

## VIM STARTER PACK

So you decided to man up and learn Vim? Don't worry, this guide will cover the basics and will serve as a jumpstart to your journey to mastering Vim.

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**A**re you frustrated with your current editor? Not able to code as fast you can think? Worry not cuz' we've got you covered with this amazing guide to the best editor in the world, Vim (You heard that right, emacs).

## WHAT IS VIM AND WHY SHOULD I LEARN IT?

In the 1970s, computer screens didn't have a GUI and had very low refresh rates. So low in fact, that single key-strokes took whole seconds to register. Developers found that frustrating to work on with normal text editors. Something about necessity, mothers and invention and Voila! Vim was created, a text editor that could do extensive editing with just a few keystrokes. How does it do that? Well, Vim is what one calls a modal text editor which basically means, it has different modes that assign different functionality to the keys. In conventional text editors, there is only one mode where the keys input text and some keys perform functions when used in conjunction with the control key. In Vim, that is just one of its many modes called "insert". Other modes have different bindings to the keys. For example, "x" deletes a character in "normal" mode.

Combine this with touch typing and you will be spewing code as fast as you can think.

If you've dealt with Unix systems, you would know that Vim comes installed by default. Apart from that, Vim has a port to almost every platform imaginable. Hence, it would be a one time investment in learning it and you can use it everywhere. Some loyalists have gone a step further and have developed plugins to be able to

## Initial Setup:

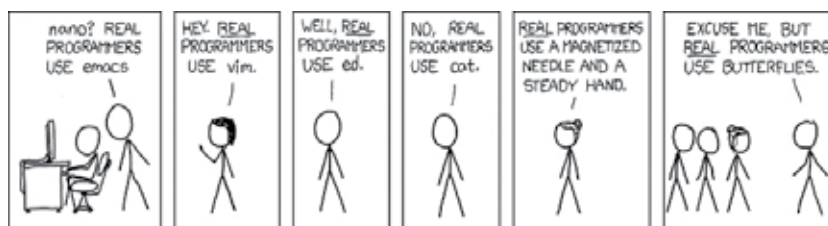
Linux:

If you're on Linux, chances are Vim is already installed. Update to the latest version by running the following.

```
$ sudo apt-get update
```

Windows

If you have the Windows subsystem for Linux installed, Vim would have been installed by default. It can be accessed via the bash terminal. If you



This could go on for a while!

use Vim in services like, Gmail, web browsers and even iTunes. Additionally, Vim can be hacked and customized, extensively. It has its own scripting language called VimL to create plugins. Here are some popular ones -

- Fugitive - A Sweet git integration.
- Syntastic - Syntax checker with support for almost any language you can think off.
- Nerdtree - Adds a tree explorer functionality.
- YouCompleteMe - The Autocomplete plugin.

don't, you could install the executable from Vim's website ([vim.org](http://vim.org)).

Mac

Vim can be installed on a Mac via Homebrew. If you don't have Homebrew installed, check out MacVim, the Mac port for Vim. Although it's an unofficial port, Vim developers themselves recommend it.

Once you have Vim installed, you can open a file by typing the following in the terminal.

```
$ vim my_great_code.c
```

Image xkcd: <http://xkcd.in/RealProg>